Basic Human Rights

1. You have the right to indulge in self-care.
2. You have the right to make mistakes and to accept the consequences of those mistakes.
3. You have the right to be the judge of your feelings and accept them as legitimate.
4. You have the right to own and accept responsibility for your own opinions.
5. You have the right to change your mind and decide on a different course of action.
6. You have the right to respectfully protest unfair treatment or criticism.
7. You have the right to respectfully ask for clarification.
8. You have the right to respectfully negotiate for change.
9. You have the right to respectfully ask for help or emotional support.
10. You have the right to decline the advice of others.
11. You have the right to feel and express pain.
12. You have the right to expect recognition for your accomplishments.
13. You have the right to say no as it relates to you, but not to decline permission as it relates to others.
14. You have the right to request alone time.
15. You have the right to respectfully explain yourself to others, but can refuse to defend yourself.
16. You have the right to accept responsibility for your behavior, thoughts, and feelings and can decline taking responsibility for someone else's behavior, thoughts and feelings.
17. You have the right to respectfully express your needs and wishes.
18. You have the right to be concerned about how your words and behavior ultimately impact others.
19. You have the right to respond, rather than react.

Remember…these are not only *YOUR* basic human rights, they are also the basic human rights of *OTHERS.*

Adapted from the Domestic Abuse Project (DAP) Men's and Women's Treatment Manual, Minneapolis, Minnesota.

Self-Control Plan

Instructions

During your time in the program, you will need to develop your own **Self-Control Plan**. During group, you will be required to present your Self-Control Plan and be prepared for the group members to offer feedback.

The Sample Self-Control Plan will give you plenty of ideas about "cues of escalation." Also, the sample includes examples on how to deal with stressful situations. If you are stuck, you can ask the facilitator or another group member for help, but make sure you call someone who has already presented a good plan.

Rate your cues as levels (Low, Medium, or High). This plan should include ideas for **Time-Outs** (leaving the situation *temporarily* so that you can calm down and remain non-abusive). Also, you should refresh the list of people that you can call for support. Positive self-talk statements are meant to help you calm down and feel positive about being non-abusive.

Requirements for a Workable Self-Control Plan

1. All cues rated 1 to 9 OR Low, Medium, and High
2. There needs to be at least 7 cues in every category. Three cues must be low-level cues (1-3), two cues must be medium-level cues (4-6), and two cues must be high-level cues (7-9).
3. Your timeout needs to include: the level of escalation for taking a time-out, the signal to your partner, where you will go/what you will do during the timeout, the length of the timeout and how you will return to the situation after the timeout.
4. At least 5 Positive Self-talk statements that you will use to calm down.
5. A regular non-competitive and non-violence exercise program that you are willing to practice at least 3 times a week. *Be realistic about your goals.*
6. At least 5 stress-reducing activities that will help you relax.

Commit to using your Self-Control Plan on an ongoing basis, daily and weekly, for as many months and years as it take for it to become a fully integrated way of life. Remember that this plan is in its formative stages and you will need to revise it as you become increasingly aware of cues and as you develop additional tools to remain non-violent.

Cues…What are they?

In this program, you will hear about something called ***cues***. The following definitions and examples are designed to explain what is meant by *cues*. *This handout should be used to assist when filling out your **Self-Control Plan**.

It can be helpful to think of cues as signals or warnings. Cues let you know that you are in danger of acting abusively. They are signals given before an incident of violence or abuse. Your cues are part of the buildup or escalation phase of the progression/cycle of violence.

PAY ATTENTION TO YOUR CUES, so that you can take a timeout when you need to. It is your responsibility to watch your cues and to leave before you behave abusively. Cues let you know that you are under stress. It is especially important to watch for cues that you have identified as having happened before your past abusive incidents.

We have divided the cues into six different types in order to help you sort out your own cues. Within each type, it is important to identify different levels of cues, from level 1 through level 9.

1) Situations: Occurrences or scenarios that contribute to your feeling of escalation and precede abusive behavior. The following situational cues may be events, incidents, or circumstances that occur when you get angry:

- Arguments
- Discipline of children
- Major decisions
- Bad day at work
- Money issues
- Holidays
- Bad weather
- Traffic/being late

2) Emotions: Feelings you experience during escalation.
The following are examples of emotional cues or feeling words that you may associate with escalation:

- Powerlessness
- Hatred
- Confusion
- Hurt
- Anger
- Embarrassment
- Rage
- Frustration

3) <u>Physical Changes</u>: This is the way your body registers stress. It includes a variety of physical sensations that you may feel when anger escalates. Examples include:

- ❖ Tension in your back
- ❖ Deeper breathing
- ❖ Tunnel vision
- ❖ Increased heart rate
- ❖ Sweating
- ❖ Stomach in knots

4) <u>Red Flag Words</u>: These are words that you say out loud or hear before acting abusively. (Put downs, swearing, name-calling do not count because these are all part of your explosion, not part of the tension-building phase.)

- ➢ **<u>My partner's:</u>** What your partner says before you become abusive. If you escalate when he/she asks you to do something, then his/her question is a red flag to you. Remember, that the point here is not to blame your partner or to get him/her to change his/her request. The point is to *identify* what he/she says that you respond to by escalating.
- ➢ **<u>Mine:</u>** What you hear yourself say that tells you that you are escalating. These should be words that come <u>before abuse</u>, such as "leave me alone, I can't stand this, don't bug me." These are not abusive words, such as "F--- you."

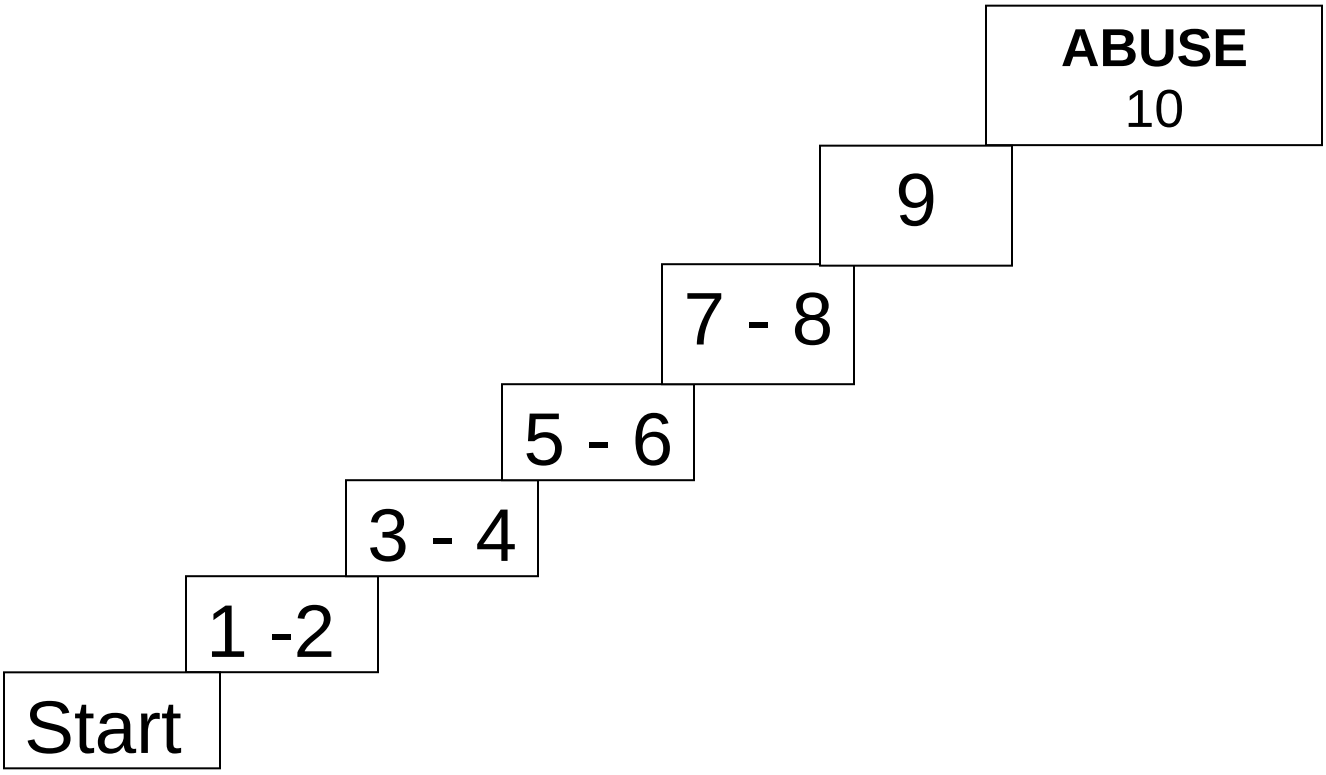
5) <u>Negative Self-talk</u>: These are negative messages that you tell yourself (not aloud). These thoughts can lead to abusive. Negative self-talk can be about you or your partner. Examples include:

- ❖ *I can't do anything right*
- ❖ *I'll show him/her who is boss*
- ❖ *I hate this crap*

6) <u>Mental Images</u>: These are images or pictures you see in your head during your buildup. Some people say that they picture the violent incident in their minds before the explosion; others describe negative situations beforehand. Examples include:

- ❖ Imagining your partner watching TV all day
- ❖ Imagining your partner being intimate with someone else
- ❖ Imagining your partner saying negative things about you to others
- ❖ Leaving work and picturing the house being dirty when you get home

Escalation Levels and Cues



Cues of escalation before violence: Situations, words, physical changes, and feelings that precede abusive behavior or that contribute to your feelings of escalation.

LEVEL	EXAMPLE CUES
1 – 2	Didn't get enough sleep – feeling tired.
3 – 4	There was traffic on the way to work – arrived late.
5 – 6	Boss yells at me, tells me that my work is shoddy; In my head, I can see all the bills piling up on the kitchen table.
7 – 8	As soon as I get in the door, my partner asks if I remembered to get the groceries.
9	Negative self-talk: "I can't stand this anymore!" I feel like slapping him/her.

Sample Self-Control Plan

TYPES OF CUES	LOW LEVEL	MEDIUM LEVEL	HIGH LEVEL
Situations	**1** – Visa bill arrived, payday isn't until next week **2** – late for work	**1** – kids fighting with each other **2** – 100 degree weather for three weeks, and have outside job	**1** – holiday dinner turns into family feud **2** – partner is angry after watching a TV movie about domestic violence
Emotions	**1** – frustrated about the dirty house **2** – guilty about a night out with the boys	**1** – ashamed when bill collector calls **2** – angry with landlord	**1** – terrified about losing my job **2** – feeling jealous while watching partner and best friend dance
Physical Changes	**1** – sore muscles **2** – faster breathing	**1** – rapid heartbeat **2** – pacing	**1** – seeing red **2** – clenched fists
Red Flag Words *** My Partner's (what my partner says to me)**	**1** – "When are you going fix the ____?" **2** – "I work too hard."	**1** – "Don't swear in front of the kids." **2** – "You get them to stop fighting."	**1** – "Screw you!" **2** – "None of this would happen if you weren't a stupid drunk."
Red Flag Words *** Mine (what I say)**	**1** – "Leave me alone." **2** – "Do we have to talk about that now?"	**1** – "Would you stop bugging me about that?" **2** – "We'd be alright if you wouldn't spend so much money."	**1** – "Because I said so." **2** – "You'll never leave. Who else would have you?"
Negative Self-Talk	***1*** *– I'm sure I'll never get that promotion.* ***2*** *– I'll never get ahead.*	***1*** *– Who does she/he think she/he is?* ***2*** *– Why can't they just let me relax?*	***1*** *– I'll show him/her who's boss.* ***2*** *– He/she knows what's coming to her/him.*
Mental Images	**1 –** picturing my partner on the phone telling friends that I'm abusive **2-** imagining my partner watching TV all day	**1 –** picturing the kids getting in trouble **2 –** picturing my partner hiding money	**1 –** picturing myself throwing and smashing things **2 –** imaging my partner having sex with _____

Application 1: Self-Control Plan

TYPES OF CUES	LOW LEVEL	MEDIUM LEVEL	HIGH LEVEL
Situations	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**
Emotions	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**
Physical Changes	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**
Red Flag Words * My Partner's (what my partner says to me)	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**
Red Flag Words * Mine (what I say)	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**
Negative Self-Talk	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**	**1** **2** **3**
Mental Images	**1** **2**	**1** **2**	**1** **2**